

THIS IS TECHNOLOGY, CULTURE AND SCIENCE WITH A DIFFERENCE, AND THAT DIFFERENCE IS USUALLY ENOUGH TO MAKE MOST NORMAL PEOPLE GO "WTF?"

This month in ALT:

In Geek-key, learn about various extinct dog breeds, then in the feature learn how AI is being used to sing and create music. After that head on over to DGT and check out some cool tech and gadgets



Surprising shared etymologies

Algorithms helped tease out surprisingly related words, Find out what a "piano" has to do with a "plainsman", or how "fantastic" is etymologically linked to "phenotype", and the unsurprising connection between "subdue" and "education" <https://dgit.in/shrety>

WHAT'S NEW

No echo chambers on YouTube

A team of researchers crawled through YouTube comments and found a surprising amount of engagement from commenters from various political inclinations, providing evidence against the theory that people avoiding consuming content that is not aligned with their worldviews. Further, they also found that people engaged in discussions without the sole intention of trolling, and that they do not actively seek to engage with those with contradictory opinions. The researchers found that nearly 70 percent of the commenters posted at least once a month on channels across the political divide, and these made up nearly 86 percent of all the comments on the platform. The findings of the



study on YouTube comments were in line with previous studies conducted on Twitter and Reddit. When it

came to measuring the toxicity of the comments, the study found that the highest toxicity was seen in the comments around defending the channels aligned with their own political views. According to the researchers, the YouTube cannot be characterised as an echo chamber. The team is now presenting ideas on how YouTube can increase the quality of cross partisan conversations.

<https://dgit.in/echowut>

Narcissism in US presidents linked to international conflict

A study on US presidents tested them for measures of narcissism and then investigated how the narcissism in the presidents was related to international conflict. The presidents that got a high score, including Lyndon Johnson and Richard Nixon were six times more likely to take unilateral decisions to engage in a dispute



Credit: LBJ Library photo by Yoichi Okamoto

with another power, in a given year, as compared to the average levels of narcissism (among the presidents). While

the average likelihood for the US to enter into an international dispute was 4 percent, with a narcissistic president in charge, it jumped up to 29 percent, with the top three most narcissistic presidents responsible for unilaterally taking the decisions for between 33 percent to 71 percent of the disputes they initiated.

<https://dgit.in/uspresn>



Don't correct Tweeples

MIT researchers have shown that trying to correct people who post misinformation on Twitter is counterproductive, as it just leads to the original poster spewing out even more misinformation, and even more toxicity as compared to no one attempting to correct anyone in the first place.

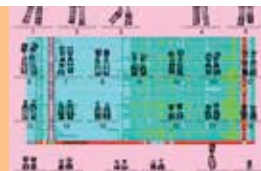
<https://dgit.in/stwtw>



Generational amnesia

From Boomers to Zoomers, each generation seems to forget the progress made by their predecessors, and at the same time underestimate the damage they have done to the planet, leading to a shifting baseline and blindsiding us in evaluating long term ecological change.

<https://dgit.in/gamn>



Human genome sequenced

A group of scientists collaborating through a Slack channel have finally sequenced the entire human genome, deciphering a string of unintelligible sequence of repeating letters that formed about 8 percent of the genome, and completing a task declared as done 20 years ago.

<https://dgit.in/humangenome>